Epic-FHIR — API category: Conformance Terminology (sections 16 – 16.1.1)

Source: Epic on FHIR (fhir.epic.com) documentation, mirrored 2026-11. Text-only edition for AI ingestion (NotebookLM); pages follow the source order (its table of contents when one exists).

16 API category: Conformance Terminology

File: site/apis/16-Conformance-Terminology/index.html

R4 (1)

API | Method | URL template | Type
ValueSet.$expand (Supported Codes) (R4) | GET | /api/FHIR/R4/ValueSet/$expand?context={context}&contextDirection={contextDirection}&filter={filter} | Industry-Standard

16.1 Conformance Terminology: R4

File: site/apis/16-Conformance-Terminology/1-R4/index.html

* ValueSet.$expand (Supported Codes) (R4)

16.1.1 ValueSet.$expand (Supported Codes) (R4)

File: site/apis/16-Conformance-Terminology/1-R4/1038-ValueSet-expand-Supported-Codes-R4.html
Epic API ID | 1038
FHIR version | R4
Categories | Conformance Terminology
API type | Industry-Standard
USCDI | No
Available in inpatient and other contexts | Yes
ONC certification products | EpicCare Ambulatory Base, EpicCare Inpatient Base
ONC certification versions | May 2020
HTTP method | GET
URL template | /api/FHIR/R4/ValueSet/$expand?context={context}&contextDirection={contextDirection}&filter={filter}
Supports OAuth 2.0 | True
Supported user types | Backend Systems and Non-OAuth 2.0, Clinicians or Administrative Users, Patients
Performs scope validation | False
Source | https://fhir.epic.com/Specifications?api=1038

Description

The ValueSet resource represents a subset of the codes in a code system that are supported by a given server. The $expand operation of the ValueSet resource can be used by a FHIR API consumer to determine:

* What values to expect back from the server as a result of a read or search interaction.

* What values they can pass in to the server when performing a create or update interaction.

The $expand operation response represents a single ValueSet resource.

Epic currently supports querying the ValueSet.$expand operation with query parameters. For example, a client may perform a query in the format /ValueSet/$expand?parameter=value.

Epic does not support querying the ValueSet.$expand operation for a specific identifier (/ValueSet/[id]/$expand).

The following resource and parameter combinations are currently supported for use with the ValueSet.$expand operation.

Claim

Path | Direction | Filter
Claim.extension | Outgoing | category:prior auth

Condition

Path | Direction | Filter
Condition.code | Outgoing | category:genomics

DeviceRequest

Path | Direction | Filter
DeviceRequest.codecodeableconcept | Outgoing

DocumentReference

Path | Direction | Filter
DocumentReference.context.extension.clinical-note-author-provider-type | Outgoing | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.context.practicesetting | Outgoing | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.docstatus | Incoming | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.docstatus | Outgoing | category:clinical-note

DocumentReference.extension/extension-documentreference.attester/mode | Outgoing | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.extension/purpose | Outgoing | category:handoff
DocumentReference.extension/service | Outgoing | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.type | Incoming | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.type | Incoming | category:document-information The following additional filters can be combined with category:document-information to further refine results. See the additional table below for accepted values. workflow - workflow descriptor level - scan attachment level resource - the FHIR ID of a resource with which the document will be associated. Example: filter=category:document-information,workflow:registration, level:encounter,resource:ej5R7X.4RdaFNR5vWdsTpVTtccmkRkWJcKixc5XVY4cQ3
DocumentReference.type | Outgoing | category:clinical-note
DocumentReference.type | Outgoing | category:document-information

DocumentReference.type Additional Filters

Workflow | Level | Resource (FHIR ID)
general | patient,encounter, or order | Not allowed
registration | patient | Patient
encounter | Encounter
referral | N/A | N/A
insurance | claim | Explanation of Benefit
coverage | Coverage
crm | CRM
employergroup | Employer Group
pbaccount | Premium Billing Account
vendor | Organization
provider | Practitioner

Encounter

Path | Direction | Filter
Encounter.type | Outgoing | category:encounter

EpisodeOfCare

Path | Direction | Filter
EpisodeOfCare.type | Incoming
EpisodeOfCare.type | Outgoing

ExplanationOfBenefit

Path | Direction | Filter
ExplanationOfBenefit.extension.levelofservicecode | Outgoing | category:preauthorization
ExplanationOfBenefit.extension | Outgoing | category:prior auth

Observation

Path | Direction | Filter
Observation.category | Outgoing | category:laboratory
Observation.method | Outgoing | category:laboratory
Observation.valuecodeableconcept | Outgoing | category:social history

Procedure

Path | Direction | Filter
Procedure.bodysite | Outgoing | category:surgical history

Questionnaire

Path | Direction | Filter
Questionnaire.code | Outgoing | category:immunization questionnaire

ServiceRequest

Path | Direction | Filter
ServiceRequest.orderdetail | Incoming | category:selected-services
ServiceRequest.orderdetail | Outgoing | category:primary-services
ServiceRequest.orderdetail | Outgoing | category:secondary-services
ServiceRequest.orderdetail | Outgoing | category:selected-services

Task

Path | Direction | Filter
Task.statusreason | Incoming
Task.statusreason | Incoming | category:completed-outcome
Task.statusreason | Incoming | category:considering-followup
Task.statusreason | Incoming | category:decline-reason
Task.statusreason | Outgoing
Task.statusreason | Outgoing | category:completed-outcome
Task.statusreason | Outgoing | category:considering-followup
Task.statusreason | Outgoing | category:decline-reason

Request parameters

Name | Type | Optional | Array | Cardinality | Description
context | string | Required | Yes | | The path to the element in the resource. * Expected format: <ResourceName>.<ElementPath> * Example: DocumentReference.type

contextdirection | string | Required | Yes | | Specifies the direction of the interaction with regards to the ValueSet. Options include "outgoing" or "incoming". * outgoing - for query parameters and response content * incoming - for incoming POST/PUT body content
filter | string | Optional | Yes | | A filter string used to further refine the ValueSet context to a specific sub-resource based on the resource's category element, and in some cases, additional details. * Example: filter=category:clinical-note

Response elements

Name | Type | Optional | Array | Cardinality | Description
ValueSet (R4) | ValueSet | | | | A single ValueSet resource.
ValueSet (R4).expansion | BackboneElement | | | 0..1 | ValueSet expansion details.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.contains | BackboneElement | | Yes | 0..* | Array of codes in the ValueSet.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.contains.code | code | | | 1..1 | Code value.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.contains.display | string | | | 0..1 | Display value associated with the code.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.contains.system | uri | | | 0..1 | System value for the code.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.parameter | BackboneElement | | Yes | 1..* | The query parameters in the $expand request.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.parameter.name | string | | | 1..1 | Parameter name as assigned by the client or server.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.parameter.valueCode | code | | | 0..1 | Parameter value. Used with the contextDirection parameter.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.parameter.valueString | string | | | 0..1 | Parameter value. Used with the filter parameter.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.parameter.valueUri | uri | | | 0..1 | Parameter value. Used with the context parameter.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.timestamp | dateTime | | | 1..1 | Time when the ValueSet expansion occurred.
ValueSet (R4).expansion.total | integer | | | 1..1 | Total number of codes in the expansion.
ValueSet (R4).id | id | | | 1..1 | The ValueSet FHIR ID.
ValueSet (R4).status | code | | | 1..1 | Status of the ValueSet. Always active.

Sample request

```
GET https://hostname/instance/api/FHIR/R4/ValueSet/$expand?context=DocumentReference.type&contextDirection=outgoing&filt
    er=category:clinical-note
```

Sample response


```
{
  "resourceType": "ValueSet",
  "id": "fN1VgbouNkWgEiH70dyCFug4",
  "status": "active",
  "expansion": {
    "timestamp": "2025-09-03T14:02:51Z",
    "total": 11,
    "parameter": [
      {
        "name": "category",
        "valueString": "clinical-note"
      },
      {
        "name": "context",
        "valueUri": "DocumentReference.type"
      },
      {
        "name": "contextDirection",
        "valueCode": "outgoing"
      }
    ],
    "contains": [
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "1",
        "display": "Progress Notes"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "2",
        "display": "Consults"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "3",
        "display": "Procedures"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "4",
        "display": "H&P"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "5",
        "display": "Discharge Summary"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "6",
        "display": "ED Notes"
      },
      {
```

```
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "7",
        "display": "Initial Assessments"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "8",
        "display": "ED Triage Notes"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "9",
        "display": "Case Communication"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.737880.5010",
        "code": "10",
        "display": "OR Nursing"
      },
      {
        "system": "urn:oid:1.2.840.114350.1.13.861.1.7.4.727879.34033",
        "code": "89241-4",
        "display": "Lactation Note"
      }
    ]
  }
}
```